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Technical Architect

Government Digital Service

Apply before 11:55 pm on Sunday 19th April 2026

Government Digital Service

Reference number

456251

Salary

£58,063 - £89,880

£65,163 - £89,880 (London) / £58,063 - £79,094 (National) Based on capability. The base salary of this grade is £61,005 for London and £55,403 for other locations. Offers made above this will be made up with a specialist pay allowance.

Job grade

Grade 7

Contract type

Permanent

Business area

GDS - Public Sector Ai Adoption

Type of role

Digital
Information Technology

Working pattern

Flexible working, Full-time, Job share, Part-time, Compressed hours

Number of jobs available

1

Contents

Location
About the job
Benefits
Things you need to know
Apply and further information

Location

Bristol, London, Manchester

About the job

Job summary

The Government Digital Service (GDS) is the digital centre of government. We are responsible for setting, leading and delivering the vision for a modern digital government.

Our priorities are to drive a modern digital government, by:

1. joining up public sector services
2. harnessing the power of AI for the public good
3. strengthening and extending our digital and data public infrastructure
4. elevating leadership and investing in talent
5. funding for outcomes and procuring for growth and innovation
6. committing to transparency and driving accountability

We are home to the Incubator for Artificial Intelligence (I.AI), the world-leading GOV.UK and at the forefront of coordinating the UK s geospatial strategy and activity. We lead the Government Digital and Data function and champion the work of digital teams across government.

We re part of the Department for Science, Innovation and Technology (DSIT) and employ more than 1,000 people all over the UK, with hubs in Manchester, London and Bristol.

The Government Digital Service is where talent translates into impact. From your first day, you ll be working with some of the world s most highly-skilled digital professionals, all contributing their knowledge to make change on a national scale.

Join us for rewarding work that makes a difference across the UK. You'll solve some of the nation s highest-priority digital challenges, helping millions of people access services they need

We are responsible for:

Facilitating and delivering the Cross-Government AI adoption at scale

- Defining the Principles and sharing Best Practice, baseline standards for responsible AI enablement at Scale
- Research and publish technical, deeper dives on AI enablement technologies and practices, such as AI Insights
- Operating models for AI deployment, assurance and Governance at scale
- Ensure widespread access to foundational AI tools
- Publish Digital, Data and Technology Strategy and Standards, like the Technology Code of Practice, the Service Standard and Open Standards
- Cross-government GDaD performance and assurance, including Spend Controls and AI Assurance Advisory
- GDaD Capability Development, including the GDaD pay framework

The roles we are recruiting sit at the heart of this mission, focused on strengthening the UK public sector s ability to enable and scale our AI Adoption. Join us for rewarding work that makes a difference across the UK. You'll solve some of the nation s highest-priority digital challenges, helping millions of people access services they need

Job description

The Technical Architects in the Public Sector AI Adoption unit in GDS exist to make building and buying AI technology easier in the UK Public Sector. In this role, you will work to set strategies, principles, and standards, and identify best practices, as well as supporting the adoption and embedding of these into the public sector, helping digital and data colleagues in these organisations deliver transformational change.

You will be aligned to a Grade 6 Principal Technologist who will mentor and support you, as well as set you challenging tasks to further your team s objectives.

As a Technical Architect, you will be supporting the AI Technology Enablement team to:

- undertake research, input into and shape a 10-year intent and strategy for the AI enablement, and support colleagues in gaining cross-government endorsement for this

- work with stakeholders to shape a government digital strategy geared towards harnessing AI for the public good, translating complex technical concepts into straightforward language to influence strategic decision-makers. This includes drafting strategy papers and best-practice guidance, and delivering presentations to senior stakeholders and ministers
- identify and or develop existing principles, standards and best practices and promote them, or form and lead a group of technologists from across the UK Public Sector to create these
- work with vendors to maximise their offer to the UK Public Sector, and with the Crown Commercial Service in commercial engagements with vendors
- build a network of peers across the UK Public Sector to regularly engage with
- promote your work through content written for the Knowledge hub, GOV.UK, speaking engagements and hosting community events
- help upskill others in GDS and DSIT in your specialist area

The above list of job duties is not exclusive or exhaustive and the post holder will be required to undertake such tasks as may reasonably be expected within the scope and grading of the post.

Person specification

This role requires:

- you should be excited about thinking long-term and helping deliver technology-related change, particularly within AI enablement and scaling AI
- you must have a technical background and be able to use this experience to make and guide architectural design decisions, build credibility with others, evaluate proposals and decide execution approaches characterised by risk and complexity
- you have strong written and verbal communication skills, and are able to translate complex concepts into straightforward language with ease to support wider organisational objectives
- you should have some experience working with technology suppliers

- you should be comfortable presenting to senior stakeholders, both technical (e.g. Principal GDaD professionals) and non-technical (including SCS and ministers)
- learning should be embedded in the way you approach your working week, and you should be keen to share your learning with those around you
- you should be at the top skill levels in your Digital & Data specialism, most likely from the Architecture, Data, or Software Development groups.
- you should hold, or be working towards, relevant industry certifications in AI as your technical specialism.

Benefits

There are many benefits of working at GDS, including:

- flexible hybrid working with flexi-time and the option to work part-time or condensed hours
- a Civil Service Pension with an average employer contribution of 28.97%
- 25 days of annual leave, increasing by a day each year up to a maximum of 30 days
- an extra day off for the King s birthday
- an in-year bonus scheme to recognise high performance
- career progression and coaching, including a training budget for personal development
- a focus on wellbeing with access to an employee assistance programme
- job satisfaction from making government services easier to use and more inclusive for people across the UK
- advances on pay, including for travel season tickets
- death in service benefits
- cycle to work scheme and facilities
- access to an employee discounts scheme
- 10 learning days per year
- volunteering opportunities (5 special leave days per year)

access to a suite of learning activities through Civil Service learning

Any move to Government Digital Service from another employer will mean you can no longer access childcare vouchers. This includes moves between government departments. You may however be eligible for other government schemes, including Tax Free Childcare. Determine your eligibility at https://www.childcarechoices.gov.uk

Office attendance
The Department operates a discretionary hybrid working policy, which provides for a combination of working hours from your place of work and from your home in the UK. The current expectation for staff is to attend the office or non-home based location for 40-60% of the time over the accounting period.
DSIT does not normally offer full home working (i.e. working at home); but we do offer a variety of flexible working options (including occasionally working from home).

Things you need to know

Artificial intelligence

Artificial intelligence can be a useful tool to support your application, however, all examples and statements provided must be truthful, factually accurate and taken directly from your own experience. Where plagiarism has been identified (presenting the ideas and experiences of others, or generated by artificial intelligence, as your own) applications may be withdrawn and internal candidates may be subject to disciplinary action. Please see our candidate guidance (opens in a new window) for more information on appropriate and inappropriate use.

Selection process details

The standard selection process for roles at GDS consists of:

a simple application screening process - We only ask for a CV and for you to answer 2 application questions.

- a video assessment - Candidates brought through from the application stage will be asked to submit a short video response to a question. This will be shared with the selected applicants
- a 60 minute video interview. As part of the interview process there will be a presentation exercise. Details around the presentation exercise will be shared for candidates invited for an interview.

Depending on how many applications we get, there might also be an extra stage before the video interview, for example a phone interview or a technical exercise.

In the event we receive a high volume of applications, we will conduct the initial sift against the lead criteria which is:

- Describe a time when you used your technical background to roll out an AI enabled solution aligned to strategic priorities.

In the Civil Service, we use Success Profiles to evaluate your skills and ability. This gives us the best possible chance of finding the right person for the job, increases performance and improves diversity and inclusivity. We ll be assessing your technical abilities, skills, experience and behaviours that are relevant to this role.

For this role we ll be assessing you against the following Civil Service Behaviours:

- seeing the Big Picture
- communicating and influencing
- working Together
- making Effective Decisions

We ll also be assessing your experience and specialist technical skills against the following skills defined in the Government Digital and Data Capability Framework for the Technical Architect role:

- architect for the whole context
- making architectural decisions
- strategy design
- architecture communication

Want to know more about who Government Digital and Data are? Click Here

Recruitment Timeline

Sift completion: Friday 24th April 2026

Video assessment: From Monday 27th April 2026

Panel interviews: Starting week commencing Monday 11th May 2026

Candidates that do not pass the interview but have demonstrated an acceptable standard may be considered for similar roles at a lower grade.

A reserve list will be held for a period of 12 months, from which further appointments can be made.

The Civil Service is committed to attract, retain and invest in talent wherever it is found. To learn more please see the Civil Service People Plan and the Civil Service D&I Strategy.

Please note that this role requires SC clearance, which would normally need 5 years UK residency in the past 5 years. This is not an absolute requirement, but supplementary checks may be needed where individuals have not lived in the UK for that period. This may mean your security clearance (and therefore your appointment) will take longer or, in some cases, not be possible.

For meaningful checks to be carried out, you will need to have lived in the UK for a sufficient period of time, to enable appropriate checks to be carried out and produce a result which provides the required level of assurance. Whilst a lack of UK residency in itself is not necessarily a bar to a security clearance, and expectation of UK residency may range from 3 to 5 years. Failure to meet the residency requirements needed for the role may result in the withdrawal of provisional jobs offers.

Sponsorship

DSIT cannot offer Visa sponsorship to candidates through this campaign. DSIT holds a Visa sponsorship licence but this can only be used for certain roles and this campaign does not qualify.

Feedback will only be provided if you attend an interview or assessment.

Security

Successful candidates must undergo a criminal record check.

Successful candidates must meet the security requirements before they can be appointed. The level of security needed is security check (opens in a new window).

See our vetting charter (opens in a new window).

People working with government assets must complete baseline personnel security standard (opens in new window) checks.

Nationality requirements

This job is broadly open to the following groups:

- UK nationals
- nationals of the Republic of Ireland
- nationals of Commonwealth countries who have the right to work in the UK
- nationals of the EU, Switzerland, Norway, Iceland or Liechtenstein and family members of those nationalities with settled or pre-settled status under the European Union Settlement Scheme (EUSS) (opens in a new window)
- nationals of the EU, Switzerland, Norway, Iceland or Liechtenstein and family members of those nationalities who have made a valid application for settled or pre-settled status under the European Union Settlement Scheme (EUSS)
- individuals with limited leave to remain or indefinite leave to remain who were eligible to apply for EUSS on or before 31 December 2020
- Turkish nationals, and certain family members of Turkish nationals, who have accrued the right to work in the Civil Service

Further information on nationality requirements (opens in a new window)

Working for the Civil Service

The Civil Service Code (opens in a new window) sets out the standards of behaviour expected of civil servants.

We recruit by merit on the basis of fair and open competition, as outlined in the Civil Service Commission's recruitment principles (opens in a new window).

The Civil Service embraces diversity and promotes equal opportunities. As such, we run a Disability Confident Scheme (DCS) for candidates with disabilities who meet the minimum selection criteria.

Diversity and Inclusion

The Civil Service is committed to attract, retain and invest in talent wherever it is found. To learn more please see the Civil Service People Plan (opens in a new window) and the Civil Service Diversity and Inclusion Strategy (opens in a new window).

Apply and further information

This vacancy is part of the Great Place to Work for Veterans (opens in a new window) initiative.

The Civil Service welcomes applications from people who have recently left prison or have an unspent conviction. Read more about prison leaver recruitment (opens in new window).

Once this job has closed, the job advert will no longer be available. You may want to save a copy for your records.

Contact point for applicants

Job contact :

Name : gdsrecruitment@dsit.gov.uk

Email : gdsrecruitment@dsit.gov.uk

Recruitment team

Email : gdsrecruitment@dsit.gov.uk

Further information

If you feel your application has not been treated in accordance with the Recruitment Principles and you wish to make a complaint, you should contact gds-complaints@dsit.gov.uk in the first instance.

If you are not satisfied with the response you receive you can contact the Civil Service Commission by email: info@csc.gov.uk Or in writing: Civil Service Commission, Room G/8 1 Horse Guards Road, London, SW1A 2HQ.